

to South Africa, but instead they were sent to India. I didn't see them again for six years. For a long while, neither of us knew the whereabouts of one another, or if we were dead or alive.

I fought in Africa and Italy, and notably, Monte Cassino. Never have I seen so much blood and determination as there. We led the decisive final charge on the German-held Abbey. I was proud to be a Pole that day.

The war drew to a close, and I found out my wife and daughter were still in India, but that they would be moved somewhere near London. I would be going there, too, after my service.

When we were finally reunited in London two years later, it was like a miracle. Thankfully, Mr. Churchill did not force repatriation upon the Poles. All of my brothers had died in the war in the resistance. Without the knowledge my father imparted to me about money and history, we would not have made it.

I owe my life to a handful of gold coins and chains.

Several days before we were to leave for Australia to immigrate, I received a call. "Marion, we have an open slot for America—do you want it?" I told him yes.

He said to get here as soon as possible. I ran the entire way.

Victoria Szablicki passed away on June 5, 2011. Marion passed away on June 16, just 11 days later at 100 years of age and less than two years after receiving his last medal, the Siberian Cross, from the Polish government. They had been married for over 76 years.²

You never know.

You also never know what will happen to the currency in which your money is calibrated. The dollar, the pound, the euro, and other currencies are controlled by governments. And, occasionally, governments get themselves into a jam. When they do, they don't hesitate to destroy their own currencies.

We have a reminder of one of these events—a \$100 trillion bill issued by Zimbabwe in 2009 ([Figure 7.1](#)).